

Report for Glossy Ibis (*Plegadis fulcinella*) observation.

Date: 04/17/2004

Location: Wolford Reservoir, north end; Grand County, CO, north of Kremmling; viewed from Highway 9.

Time of Observation: 1250-1320

Observers: Nick Komar, Rachel Lawson (rachellawson@softhome.net), Bob Eggleston (rbe@shentel.net), Jean Brandt (jeanbrandt@sbcglobal.net), Phil Sayer (philbird1@juno.com), Alan Condin (801-583-8501), Barbara Arum (barbara.arum@earthlink.net)

Optical Equipment: Kowa 15x-60x Zoom Telescopes, Swarovski telescope
Viewed in flight with Nikon 7x35 Action binoculars (Komar).

Distance to bird: about 150m

Other observers: none known

Viewing conditions: Bird was observed under overcast sky (good light). We faced east to observe the bird from a position approximately 20 feet above the surface of the water.

Description:

We observed an adult *plegadis* ibis in a flock of approximately 160 White-faced Ibis (*Plegadis chihi*) loafing on a sandbar at a distance of about 150 m. The bird differed from the surrounding ibis by having a dark gray face (not red), bordered above by a thin blue line that stretched from the eye (but not behind the eye) to the bill, across the top of the bill and to the opposite eye. A short, thin blue line also bordered the face on the lower edge. Above the bill, this blue line was more prominent than on the face. The legs were not observed well.

Observers' Previous Experience: Komar has observed Glossy Ibis in Massachusetts on numerous occasions between 1973 and 1997. Since 1998, Komar has observed approximately 10 Glossy Ibis in Colorado, always carefully evaluating field marks to rule out the more common White-faced Ibis in Colorado. The other observers have many years of bird observation experience and all have previously observed both *plegadis* species ibis in North America.

Consideration of Similar Species:

White-faced Ibis has a prominent continuous white line entirely bordering the facial skin, including the eye (as opposed to thin disjunct blue lines in Glossy Ibis). Other dark western hemisphere ibis (Green Ibis, Bare-faced Ibis) differ significantly from *Plegadis* species in structure.

Literature consulted:
Sibley Guide to Birds, 2001

Report prepared by Nick Komar (quetzal65@comcast.net), 4/19/2004, from memory.